

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS SIGHT RECORD REPORT
 RARE OR UNUSUAL RECORD ☐ NEW STATE RECORD

CFO-ORC FILE # 5-74-53

Accepted JR 4/8/74

Species: Little blue Heron
 (Vernacular Name)

Florida caerulea
 (Scientific Name-use binomial)

Date(s): 26 May 1974 Time Bird Seen: 12:15 to 1:30 PM

Locality: Monte Vista Wildlife Refuge

County: Rio Grande

Other observers who identified this bird:

NAME ADDRESS

TELEPHONE

Shirley M Wheeling

203 Victor St Aurora 80011

3431475

Jonathan R Wheeling

" " " "

Optical Equipment: Binocular (Bushnell Custom 9x36) spotting Scope - Bushnell
 Conditions: Excellent - Full Sun Spennaster x20 - x45

Distance from Bird (how measured): Estimate 30 Yards - Later 75 Yards
Observed from Car - Later from Road

Number of Birds Seen: ONE Sex: Unk Plumage: Adult

Overall Appearance and Size: Slender, upright Heron approx 24 in height

Detailed Description (describe only what was actually observed in the field):

Bill (shape and color): Short, pointed very dark bill w/ lighter at base
 Legs (shape and color): 4 Feet very dark (appears black standing & flying)
 Crown and Forehead: Head & Neck - Reddish-Purple darkening over Eye (color): Not seen
 Face: Throat: Shoulders

Neck and Sides:

Wings and Flanks:

Undertail Coverts:

Back:

Wings:

Underwings:

Camp:

Upper Side of Tail:

Under Side of Tail:

Shape of Tail:

Dark blue - Black appearing depending upon
angle of incident light from observer
 Undertail Coverts:

Voice: Not heard

Behavior: Slow, deliberate Movement & Feeding on shore or within a foot or two of shore
Sed, Rested & Flushed w/ small flock of Snowy Egrets [No Trees]
 Habitat: Fresh water Pond - Shallow - Multiple small islands - Short rushes & mixed veg.
 Prior Experience with this Species: Seen on occasion by JMW in Southern
Michigan - Not previously recorded by me

How Were Similarly Appearing Species Eliminated? Should not be easily confused
with others.

This Report was Written From: Notes made during XX after observation; Memory

Signed: James R Wheeling Street Address: 203 Victor St

Date Prepared: 1 June 1974 Town and State: Aurora Colo Zip 80011